

Salesforce Developer Bridge Program

Day 1 — Self-Learning Track (Cohort of 80)

You've been given a conditional offer with one month to strengthen the exact skills flagged in the interview: writing Apex code, SOQL, triggers, LWC components, and thinking through real Salesforce workflows. There is no live trainer running these sessions — you are learning in small pods, and the structure below replaces what a trainer would normally catch.

How This Works for 80 People Without a Trainer

1. Pods of 5

80 students are split into 16 pods of 5. Stay in the same pod for this week.

2. Every task has an "Expected Result"

Don't move to the next task until your output matches it. If it doesn't, that's your bug to find — not a trainer's job to spot for you.

3. Daily 20-minute pod call, end of day

Each person shares their screen for 3-4 minutes and explains, out loud, what their code does. The other four ask "why did you do it that way?" at least once. Explaining code out loud to peers exposes gaps that silent self-checking never will.

4. Rotating Pod Lead

Each pod rotates a Pod Lead daily. The Lead's job: skim the pod's 5 submissions (15 min), and fill in one row of the Issue Log (template at the end of this note) — the single most common mistake seen in the pod, and how many people it affected.

5. Coordinator roll-up — this is what makes Day 2 adaptive

Whoever is coordinating the program collects all 16 pods' Issue Logs at the end of each day, identifies the 3-5 most common mistakes across the whole cohort, and adds them to the top of the next day's note as "Yesterday's Common Mistakes." This is how the program adapts without a trainer teaching live — the material itself gets corrected daily based on what actually went wrong.

6. When you're stuck and no one in your pod knows the answer

- **Trailblazer Community:** trailhead.salesforce.com/trailblazer-community/feed — search your exact error message; nearly every Trailhead error has been posted before
- **Salesforce Stack Exchange:** salesforce.stackexchange.com — best for "why does my code do X" questions
- Post in your pod's group chat — someone may have hit the same wall

7. Shared tracker

A single shared spreadsheet with all 80 names: task done / stuck on / help needed. This is the substitute for a trainer noticing someone has fallen behind.

Your workspace

Sign up for a free Trailhead Playground (trailhead.salesforce.com) if you don't already have a Developer Org. Do all hands-on work there.

Block 1: Data Model Refresh (1.5 hrs)

Trailhead (redo even if done before)

- [Data Modeling](#)
- [Object Relationships](#)

Task 1 — Design a mini data model

Each pod picks ONE scenario (different pods should pick different ones — you'll compare notes across pods later):

- A Car Service Center — vehicles, appointments, technicians, invoices
- A College Library — books, members, issue records, fines
- A Hospital OPD — patients, doctors, appointments, prescriptions

Steps:

1. On paper first: what are the objects? Standard vs Custom? Lookup vs Master-Detail relationships?
2. Build it for real in your Trailhead Playground.

Expected Result

Object Manager shows at least 2 custom objects with at least one relationship field connecting them. Screenshot it.

Peer check (before end of day)

Show your data model to your pod. Each person should be able to say, out loud, why you chose Lookup vs Master-Detail for each relationship. If someone can't explain it, that's today's real task — not the screenshot.

Block 2: Apex Basics — Classes, Variables, SOQL (2.5 hrs)

Watch

- [Apex Hours — Fundamentals of Apex for Salesforce](#)
- [Apex Hours YouTube channel](#) — Apex Basics playlist

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- [Apex Basics & Database](#)

Task 2 — Write it yourself

Type out every code example from the module by hand in Execute Anonymous (Debug menu, Developer Console), run it, read the debug log. Don't just click the Trailhead checker without running it yourself first.

Expected Result

Your debug log shows output matching what the module describes. If you see an error instead, that's a real bug — search the exact error message (see "stuck" section above) before moving on.

Task 3 — SOQL practice

Using your Task 1 objects, write and run these 5 queries. Save each query + its output into a text file:

3. WHERE clause query
4. ORDER BY + LIMIT
5. Relationship query (parent-to-child or child-to-parent)
6. Aggregate query with COUNT() or GROUP BY
7. Comparison operator ($\geq$) on a date or number field

Expected Result

All 5 queries return results without a syntax error (a valid empty result is fine — an error is not). Query #3 is usually the hardest — bring it to your pod call if stuck.

Block 3: Apex Triggers (2 hrs)

Watch

- [The Complete Guide to Apex Triggers](#)
- [Apex Trigger Mastery: Beginner to Advanced](#) — first hour today, rest as homework

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- [Apex Triggers](#)

Task 4 — Write a real trigger

On your Task 1 object, write a trigger that:

8. Before Insert: Prevents a duplicate record (e.g., stop two appointments for the same vehicle on the same date)
9. After Update: Updates a field on a related record
10. Structure: Logic must live in a separate handler class, called from the trigger — not written directly in the trigger body

Expected Result

Insert a duplicate through the UI → it should be blocked with a clear error message. Update a record that should cascade → the related record's field should change. Screenshot both.

Peer check

On your pod call, one person deliberately tries to break another's trigger (insert 5 records at once via Data Import, not one at a time). If it fails, note it — you'll fix bulk-safety on Day 2, so it's fine if it breaks today, just document what happened.

Block 4 (Homework Tonight): LWC Introduction

Watch

Search "Lightning Web Components basics" on Salesforce Developers YouTube channel.

Trailhead

- [Lightning Web Components Basics](#)

Task 5 — Build one simple component

Create an LWC displaying records from your custom object using @wire.

Expected Result

The component renders in your Playground's Lightning App Builder (add it to a Home page to preview) and shows real record data, not blank or an error.

End of Day — Submit to Your Shared Tracker

11. Screenshot: Object Manager showing your data model
12. Text file: your 5 SOQL queries + output
13. Screenshot: trigger blocking a duplicate + trigger cascading an update
14. Your LWC component files (zip the folder)
15. One line: "Today I learned ____, and I'm still stuck on ____"
16. Attend your 20-min pod call — not optional

Pod Lead: skim all 5 submissions, fill in one row of the Issue Log below.

Pod Issue Log — Fill in and send to your Coordinator

One row per pod. The Coordinator will combine all 16 pods' entries to build "Yesterday's Common Mistakes" for Day 2.

Pod #	Pod Lead Name	Most Common Mistake Seen	# Affected	Question to Escalate

Treat every task today like part of your final mini-project — that's what got the company's attention in the interview.